

Game Design Document

Project codename: Beebop Tapper

Game title TBD

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1.0 Summary

1.1 Game Genre and World

Project Beebop Tapper is a 2D arcade game inspired by the old atari arcade game of Tapper. It will also have elements of Overcooked, where NPCs who arrive at the bar will display their order above their head, and the player will have to serve them their drink by either pouring a beer then serving or combining certain ingredients to make a cocktail. Once the drink is served, the NPC will leave cash on the bar which contributes to the players overall score. There is a time limit to serve the customers and to collect the cash to be on the counter before they leave/walk away. The player has to manage making and serving drinks and collecting money for a high-score. The level (the barkeeper's shift) will end after a certain amount of time. When the time runs out, it will trigger an 'End of Night' displaying the score so far.



1.2 Setting and Universe

In the not so distant future, the player is looking for a job to pay off their student space loans. Bartending is a lucrative, yet stressful, position to have. The game is set in a bar on the planet of Mars. With the ambience inspired by the Cowboy Beebop universe (futuristic steampunk?) the bar is run down and grimy, but standing strong. To flesh out the setting for the player (since it's an arcade game atm), the NPCs could be various humans, cyborgs, aliens, robots, space cowboys, and maybe have a window in the background displaying the landscape.

1.3 Story Overview (Can be changed later, not important for arcades)

As previously mentioned, the context for the player is to pay off their student space loans by barking in a tavern on Mars. The player manages serving the colourful clientele of the roaming space cowboys. (It could be determined at a later date, that the player makes their way to the top and manages the bar as a whole, but that is a back burner idea.)

The player will experience progression with the end of nights. To proceed to the next night, the player must have reached a certain score or else they will be 'Fired' for having making enough money. Between each night, the player can purchase upgrades for the bar, making it bigger to accommodate more guests, but also making it harder for the player to serve the larger clientele. The player could also purchase new and more complicated drinks that contribute to a higher score, but also takes longer to make.

1.4 Art Style

The art style would be in 16 or 32 bit to fit the arcade feel. It should reflect the ambiance of steampunk or futuristic anime such as Cowboy Beebop, Trigun, Space Dandy, Firefly.

The palette More muted, run down colours for the backgrounds and bar. The player and NPCs should be more colourful for better visibility and to represent the various characters who frequent taverns.

The items, and stations to make drinks will also have to be a septa loud colour not used by characters or the background for better visibility. These items will also have a blinking effect to display their interactivity.

To complete this, a triadic or rectangular colour combination may be best, as the background could almost be monochromatic, varying through shades of the same colour, to help the player, NPCs and intractable items stand out more. This could also help various decoration (like

Neon) stick out to place the player in the games setting. Please see the various colour palette suggestions below for a better understanding.

1.5 Music

TBD. The music will have to invoke an arcade race against time feel or reflect the grimy space ambiance of the bar.

The menus and the beginning of the ‘Nights’ should have a similar chill bar vibe that invokes space. As the night progresses, the music should pick up in tempo to invoke stress and speed in the player.

1.6 Sound Fx

The player should be able to hear various sounds from triggered interactions during gameplay. Please see the following examples on how sound FXs that can affect the gameplay feel:

- The BeerTap Mini game should play a sliding whistle noise as the hit bar goes up and down the timing bar.
- The Cocktail Shaker should play a SFX that resembles ice shaking in a cocktail Shaker
- While playing the Cocktail Mini game, when hitting the keys in rhythm with the UI, a delightful chime should be played with coincide with a score multiplier. (See Game Mechanics)
- When a patron drops coins, a noise of coins dropping a table should be played.
- When a patron walks away, we can have them mumble on the terrible service if they were not served

2.0 User Interface

When the user starts up the game, they will be presented with the options for “New Game”, “Tutorial”, “Continue/Load” if the game is developed beyond just an arcade romp, “Settings”, and “Credits”. The “Pause” menu is accessed when pausing during gameplay.

2.1 New Game

When the player hits “New Game”, a new game is created. The player will be brought to the next screen where they be suggested to play the tutorial with the option on “No” by default. If the game is developed beyond an arcade romp to just get a high score, the user will be able to create and customize a character (See Player in Character section).



2.2 Continue/Load

This allows the user to be brought to a screen where they can load or delete a past saved game. This option will only be given if the game is developed beyond just an arcade romp. Pl

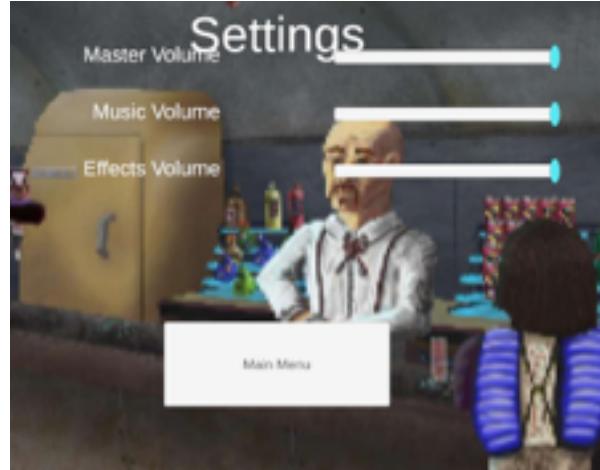
2.3 Pause Menu

When the player is in game, they can pause the game. In this menu, the player will have the option to load a past save, restart their shift (level), see their current score, access the setting menu or quit the game entirely.

The player can only be able to save their game in between nights/levels. When player loads a previous save, the game will start at the begging of the last uncompleted night/level.

2.4 Settings

In this menu, the player will be presented 3 different menu tabs: Controls, Graphics and Audio. In controls, the player will be able to adjust their key bindings or controller binding types. In graphics, the screen resolution can be adjusted, along with the image quality (for PC). In the Audio tab, there will be a slider bar for master volume, music, dialog (for the tutorial) and sound effects.



2.5 Credits

In the credits menu, the player would be able to see game credits, such as the name of the developers, music and engine license and their overall game progress and the high score leaderboard.

3.0 Characters

3.1 Player Character

If the game is developed beyond a simple arcade romp, the player will be able to customize their character. They can choose their hairstyle, skin tone, shirt and eye colours. Also, as per the world universe, it should, but isn't necessary, to fit within the space setting. There is room for the artist to get creative here in player customization, to be as wacky with the space theme. If we go beyond an arcade romp, for a sense of progression, the player could buy additional assets for customization.

However, these days there is no 1 kind of uniform, so we are proceeding with a cheesy/classic getup. Presenting Samson Phobos:



3.2 NPC Characters

The NPCs will be various clientele who simply walk up and sit at the bar. Once seated, a speech bubble will appear above their head displaying the drink that they wish to order. Either a pint of beer or a cocktail of a certain colour. The NPC will wait for a total of 90-120 seconds (TBD later when balancing). Within 15 seconds of this timer ending, they will begin to vibrate with anger before leaving unhappy. When the player serves them their drink, a heart will be displayed in their speech bubble and they will leave a pile of cash next to them on the bar. They will then proceed to play a drinking animation (throwing their head back) followed by walking away from the bar. The artist has free liberty to create the sprites and the animations of 5-10 different NPCs within the constraint of the in-game universe setting previously mentioned.



4.0 Game Mechanics

4.1 Walking

The player will have the option to walk from left to right behind the bar using the “W” and “D” keys. The “W” and “S” keys can be used to change which way the player faces at the bar to interact with either the clients and money at the bar or with the fridge for ingredients behind them.

The player can hit ‘E’ to interact with the Beer Tap and Cocktail Shaker to trigger their respective mini games, as well as pick up ingredients from the corresponding fridges. The player can then hit ‘F’ to give patrons their drinks.

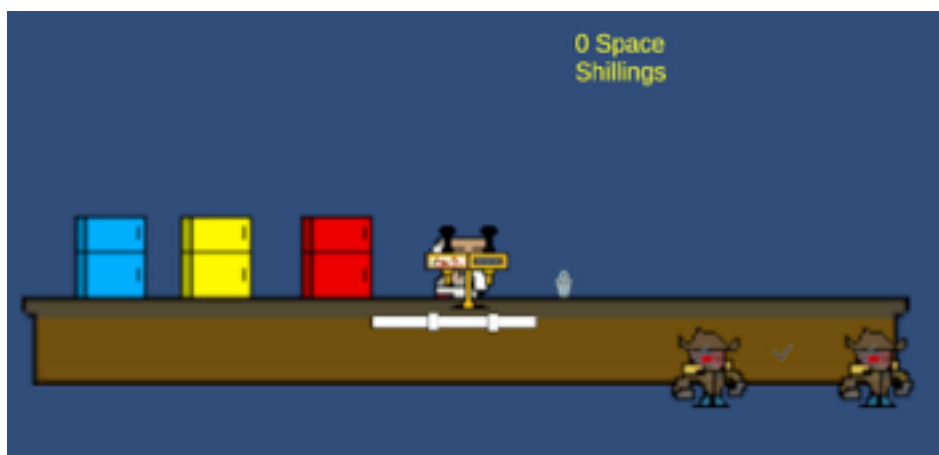
4.2 NPC Interaction

Once the NPCs sit at the bar, a speech bubble will appear above their head displaying their order either a colour coded cocktail or a beer. The player is able to serve the drink by pressing the “E” or ‘F’ key in proximity to the NPC they are facing. If the player interacts with the wrong NPC, the NPC with the according order will have their speech bubble vibrate with a sound cue. Once served, the NPC will leave cash on the bar, drink and then leave.



4.3 Pouring Beers

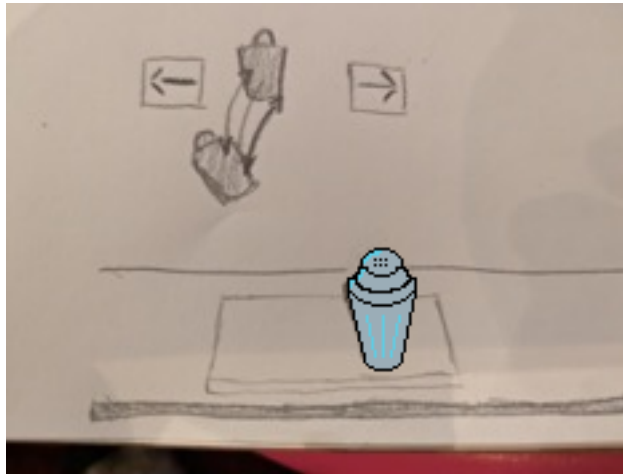
The player can pour a beer from the beer tap at the far left end of the bar. They simply walk up the beer-tap, and use “E” to interact while facing it. A UI animation will then proceed to play. A white ‘Tick’ will slide up and down a bar with a stationary tick. If the player hits ‘Space Bar’ when the moving tick aligns with the stationary tick, a UI prompt of the word ‘Hit’ along with a **+5** will display to reward the player a bonus to their score, along with a Beer Item in their inventory, which will be displayed in a square in a top corner of the screen. If the player fails the timing, they will still receive a beer, however, they will not receive a bonus.



4.4 Making Cocktails

To make a cocktail, the player must collect 2 ingredients from the fridge behind the bar. For example, if the cocktail is purple (see examples from NPC interactions), the player must collect a blue and a red ingredient from the fridge by facing the appropriate part of the fridge (using the “W” key) and hitting “E” (**Currently, the player only has to hit ‘E’**). The colour coded ingredients will be displayed at the top right corner of the screen. The player can only hold onto 2

ingredients at a time. Once all ingredients are collected, the player can then interact with the cocktail shaker.



The cocktail mini game is currently being developed resembling a rhythm game. A UI prompt of left and right arrows will be displayed over the players head. The Arrows will alternate between white and black and should blink in tandem with the music that is

playing. The arrows will alternate up to 5 times total. The player must time their Key Presses, ‘A’ and ‘D’, when the corresponding arrow is white. When the player succeeds in hitting their key with the proper timing, it will affect their score multiplier which will affect the score the player will receive once the drink is served. For example, if the player times correctly the key press with the music 3 out of 5 times, they will receive a x3 to the base amount of coins they will receive from the patron.

4.5 Collecting Money

Once an NPC is served their drink, they will drop money next to them on the bar. The player can pick on the money by clicking “E” and a chime sound cue will play. A beer will give +8 points to the player’s overall score and a cocktail will have a base point of 5 and will be affected by the multiplier that they will be able to acquire when playing the cocktail mini game. The money will only be available to pick up for 15 seconds on the bar before disappearing. 5 seconds

before the time limit for collection, the money will begin to flash to warn the payer of their imminent loss.

5.0 Items and Progression

5.1 Cosmetic items

Depending on the high score and if the game is developed beyond just an arcade romp, the player could unlock various cosmetics for their player and the bar between nights with the money they've collected so far.

5.2 Build your Bar!

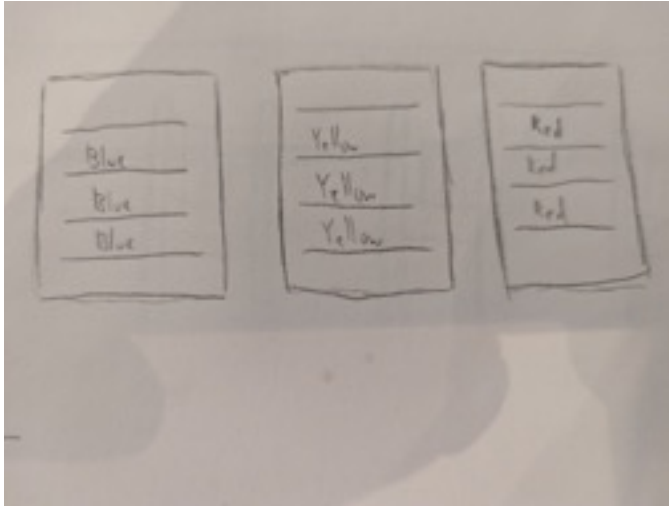
Depending if the game is developed beyond just an arcade romp, there could be multiple "nights" or levels. For the player to proceed to the next night, the player must meet a minimum amount of points or 'Space Shillings'. In between nights, the player can purchase upgrades and customizations. The player can upgrade the size and appearance of the bar, different custom clothes for the bartender or more complicated cocktails.

If the player upgrades the size of the bar, they will be able to attend to more patrons to accumulate more wealth quicker. However, it may be more difficult for the player to juggle making drinks and picking up the coins.

5.3 Drink Recipes

Depending on the high score and if the game is developed beyond just an arcade romp, the player could purchase more types of beers or more complex cocktails to make during their shift. These new beers and cocktails would give higher bonus points once completed and more money once served to the clients. The player will also have to perfect their timing when it comes to prepping these new drinks. The player can purchase these new products in the same menu as the skill tree in-between shifts.

The game will start with “Blue”, “Yellow” or “Red” ingredients in the open fridge behind the bar in three distinct areas of the wall. Combining the appropriate colours will make one of three cocktails: “Purple”, “Orange” or “Green”. each giving a different score.



5.3 Tutorial

Before starting a “New Game”, or by choosing the option in the menu, the player can perform their “training shift”. It will start with just the player behind the bar, and a robot cowboy sitting at the bar. The NPC will explain how to pour a beer and serve. Following this, he will then highlight the importance of collecting money before its “stolen”. Finally he will ask for a cocktail and explain how to interact with the fridge to collect either a blue, yellow or red ingredient to make either a purple, green or orange cocktail.

6.0 Controls for target SKUs

6.1 Computer and Code Structure

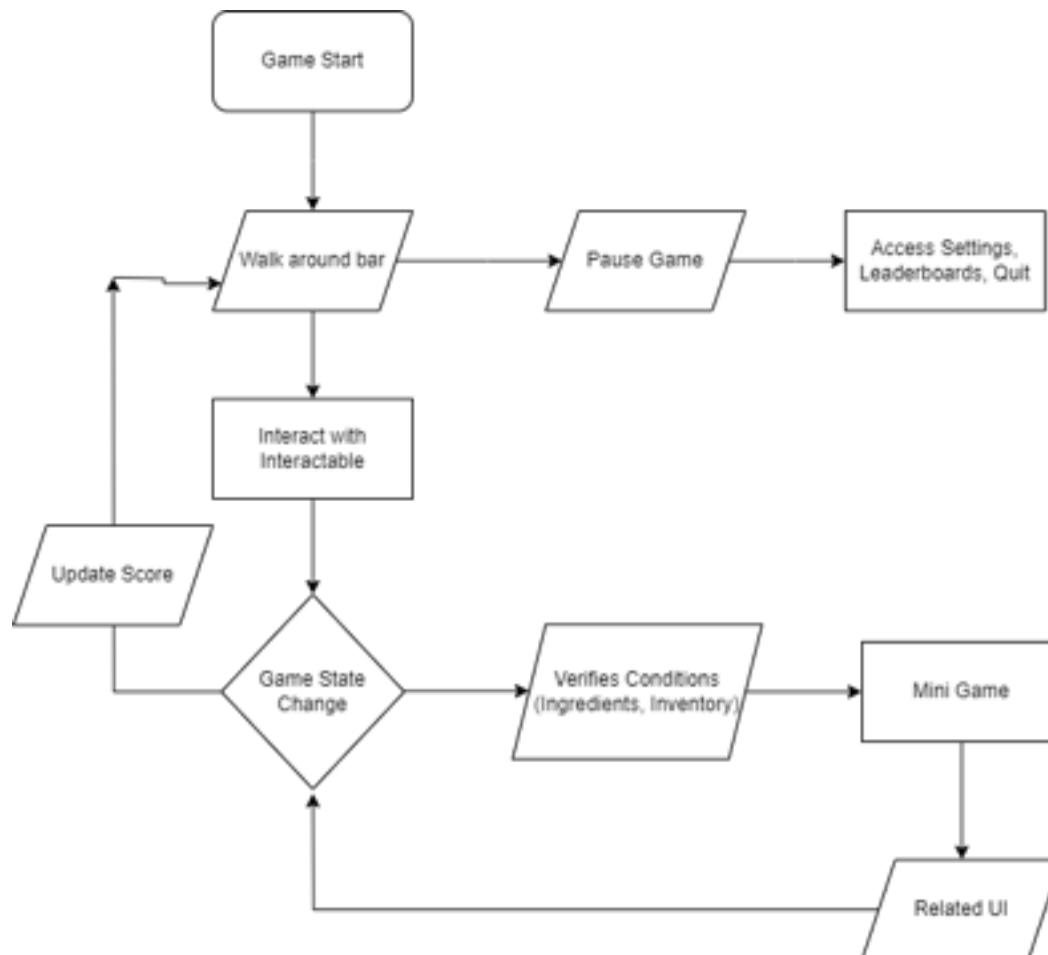
For computers, the player will use “WASD” to walk around and face different directions behind the bar. The “E” key will be used to interact/pick up ingredients, cash or the bar-tap. The arrow keys will be used to pour or shake the various drinks.

6.2 Game Play Flow Chart

Please see the flowchart below for a better understanding of the algorithm for the game-play and the code.



Game Manager manages the change in game state. When the player enters a mini game, the game object sends a variable from a function to the game manager which receives it and sends it back to begin the coroutine in the original class. Please note this is a work in progress.



6.3 Stories (Github, Trello)

To perform our actions in sprints, 2 week deadlines, I have organized Our art objectives in trello. They are written as Stories. As a player.... I want... Trello main focuses on art.

In our github project file, there is a similar board to trello. Under the “Projects” folder there is only one associated with the project. Here you can raise “Issues”, to show what you're working on, and also post others stories for future sprints.

7.0 Publishing

If ever we develop past a simple arcade romp. Including : building and customizing bar by purchasing upgrade (

7.1 Target Audience

For those wishing for a fun simple arcade game in the form as “cozy” but has a pep in their step. Feeling the pression of their actions and skills through building a fictional property/ business. **Build your bars on Mars!**

7.2 Marketing

Some marketing tips to build an audience:

- Share progress of the game on social media
- Share your artwork
- Reach out to publishers

7.3 Publishers

Publishers can cover a lot of cost of production and are the main sources of revenu. To gain one, we must complete a 15min demo, build a website, show a trailer with gameplay, explain our journey and other form of documentation. Most important, we have to email this presentation to hundreds of them.

We must build a pitch. Sell yourself and the game. Show what can be done within a time-frame. If they accept, they pay advances which cover up to certain deadlines. To keep confidence and get more funding.

For additional funding, kickstarter

To be continued...